

Problem #5: Japanese Compound Words (20 marks)

In Japanese, certain root words undergo a change at their left edge when they form compound words under specific circumstances. This phenomenon is traditionally called *Rendaku*. Examine the following examples of Japanese compound words:

Japanese words	Compound word	Gloss	Meaning
<i>hito + hito</i>	<i>hitobito</i>	person + person	people
<i>ike + hana</i>	<i>ikebana</i>	keep alive + flower	flower arrangement
<i>toki + toki</i>	<i>tokidoki</i>	time + time	sometimes
<i>te + kami</i>	<i>tegami</i>	hand + paper	letter
<i>hitori + tabi</i>	<i>hitoritabi</i>	one person + travel	travelling alone
<i>tsuno + tokage</i>	<i>tsunotokage</i>	horn + lizard	horned lizard
<i>yama + kawa</i>	<i>yamakawa</i>	mountains + rivers	mountains and rivers
<i>aka + huda</i>	<i>akahuda</i>	red + tag	red tag
<i>maki + susi</i>	<i>makizusi</i>	rolling + sushi [#]	rolled sushi
<i>yama + kawa</i>	<i>yamagawa</i>	mountain + river	mountain's river
<i>hebi + tosi</i>	<i>hebidosi</i>	snake + year	snake year
<i>eda + ha</i>	<i>edaha</i>	branches + leaves	branches and leaves
<i>oo + kaze</i>	<i>ookaze</i>	big + wind	big wind
<i>kokoro + tsukai</i>	<i>kokorodzukai</i>	heart + using	anxiety
<i>denki + kurage</i>	<i>denkikurage</i>	electric + jellyfish	electric jellyfish
<i>yuki + kaeri</i>	<i>yukikaeri</i>	coming + going	coming and going
<i>hana + sono</i>	<i>hanazono</i>	flower + garden	flower garden
<i>nise + karasu</i>	<i>nisegarasu</i>	fake + crow	fake crow

Assignment 1:

Fill in the following compound words.

Japanese words	Compound word	Gloss	Meaning
<i>wa + kasi</i>	_____	Japanese + cake	Japanese cake
<i>yama + kazi</i>	_____	mountain + fire	forest fire
<i>juzu + tsunagi</i>	_____	rosary + sequence	roping together
<i>yama + tera</i>	_____	mountain + temple	mountain temple
<i>ao + kawazu</i>	_____	green + frog	green frog
<i>uwa + huta</i>	_____	top + lid	top lid
<i>e + tako</i>	_____	picture + kite	picture kite

Assignment 2:

When compounds are made up of more than two words, things become truly interesting. Fill in the blank entries (A to E) in the following Table:

Japanese words	Compound Word	Gloss	Meaning
<i>hosi-kaki-tsukuri</i>	<i>hosi-gaki-dzukuri</i>	dried persimmon* making	making dried persimmon
<i>nise-kami-tana</i>	<i>nise-kami-dana</i>	fake divine altar	a divine altar that is fake
<i>nise-kami-tana</i>	<i>nise-gami-dana</i>	fake divine altar	an altar for a fake God
<i>ori-kami-tana</i>	<i>ori-gami-tana</i>	fold paper shelf	origami shelf
<i>nise-sakura-dayori</i>	A. ?	fake cherry-blossom tidings	tidings of fake cherry-blossoms
<i>nise-sakura-dayori</i>	<i>nise-sakura-dayori</i>	fake cherry-blossom tidings	fake tidings of

			cherry-blossoms
<i>nuri-hasi-hako</i>	<i>B. ?</i>	lacquered chopstick box	a box for lacquered chopsticks
<i>nuri-hasi-hako</i>	<i>nuri-hasi-bako</i>	lacquered chopstick box	a lacquered box for chopsticks
<i>nise-tanuki-siru</i>	<i>C. ?</i>	pseudo tanuki** soup	soup made from pseudo tanuki
<i>nise-tanuki-siru</i>	<i>D. ?</i>	pseudo tanuki soup	tanuki soup that is not authentic
<i>oya-ko-kenka</i>	<i>E. ?</i>	parent child quarrel	parent and child quarrel

Japanese is spoken by about 125 million speakers primarily in Japan.

#**sushi** is cooked vinegared rice combined usually with raw fish.

***persimmon** is a fruit.

****tanuki** is Japanese raccoon dog.

- Zarana Sarda